

UPSC Prelims

Environment & Ecology

Class No. 11

International Conventions Part 2

REDD and UN-REDD+



UN-REDD	REDD+
The UN Programme on Reducing Emissions from Deforestation and Forest Degradation (UN-REDD). Headquarters: Geneva, Switzerland. Membership: 64 Partner Countries.	Reducing emissions from deforestation & forest degradation Role: Conservation, sustainable management of forests and enhancement of forest carbon stocks in developing countries
It is a multilateral collaborative programme of FAO, UNDP and UNEP. It was created in 2008 in response to the UNFCCC decisions on the Bali Action Plan and REDD.	Voluntary climate change mitigation approach that has been developed by Parties to the UNFCCC.

REDD and UN-REDD+



UN-REDD	REDD+
The main goal of REDD is to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by incentivizing countries to preserve their forests instead of cutting them down. The program achieves this by providing financial incentives to countries that reduce their deforestation rates.	REDD+ goes beyond deforestation and forest degradation and aims to incentivize developing countries to reduce emissions from deforestation and forest degradation, conserve forest carbon stocks, sustainably manage forests and enhance forest carbon stocks. The "+" in REDD+ refers to these additional activities.

REDD+ also includes a **stronger emphasis on the involvement of local communities** and indigenous peoples in forest conservation and management, as well as the protection of biodiversity and ecosystem services.

Forest Carbon Partnership Facility

- It is a global partnership of governments, businesses, civil society, and Indigenous peoples focused on reducing emissions from activities commonly referred to as REDD+:
 1. deforestation and forest degradation, forest carbon stock conservation,
 2. the enhancement of forest carbon stocks in developing countries,
 3. the sustainable management of forests.
- The World Bank assumes the functions of trustee and secretariat. The World Bank, the Inter-American Development Bank and UNDP are delivery partners under the Readiness Fund and responsible for providing REDD+ readiness support.

Forest Carbon Partnership Facility

Objectives:

1. To assist countries in their REDD+ efforts by providing them with financial and technical assistance.
2. To pilot a performance-based payment system for REDD+.
3. To test ways to sustain or enhance livelihoods of local communities and to conserve biodiversity.
4. To disseminate broadly the knowledge gained in Emission Reductions Programs (ERPs).

Climate and Clean Air Coalition (CCAC) : done already

- In 2012, a few nations, along with the UNEP, came together to form the Climate and Clean Air Coalition.
- It is a partnership of governments, public and private sector, scientific institutions, civil society organizations, etc. committed to protecting the climate through actions to reduce short-lived climate pollutants

BioCarbon Fund Initiative

- BioCarbon Fund Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes (ISFL) is a multilateral fund, supported by donor governments and managed by the World Bank.
- It seeks to promote reduced GHG emissions from the land sector, from deforestation and forest degradation in developing countries (REDD+), and from sustainable agriculture, as well as smarter land-use planning, policies, etc.

Cool Coalition

- It aims to inspire ambition and accelerate action on the transition to clean and efficient cooling.
- It was launched at the first Global Conference on Synergies between the 2030 Agenda and Paris Agreement in 2019.
- It is a global effort led by:
 1. UNEP
 2. Climate and Clean Air Coalition
 3. Kigali Cooling Efficiency Program
 4. Sustainable Energy for All (SEforALL)

Global Climate Change Alliance + (GCCA+)

- GCCA+ is a European Union initiative. It helps vulnerable countries on the front line of climate change.
- GCCA+ initiatives help mainly Small Islands Developing States (SIDS) and Least Developed Countries (LDCs) increase their resilience to climate change.
- It also supports these group of countries in implementing their commitments resulting from the 2015 Paris Agreement (COP21)

Global Alliance for Climate-Smart Agriculture (GACSA)

- GACSA is promoted by FAO along with various governments. Its vision is to improve food security, nutrition and resilience in the face of climate change.
- GACSA works towards three aspirational outcomes to:
 - a. Improve farmers' agricultural productivity and incomes in a sustainable way;
 - b. Build farmers' resilience to extreme weather and changing climate;
 - c. Reduce greenhouse gas emissions associated with agriculture, when possible.

GHG Protocol

- GHG Protocol is **developing standards, tools and online training** that helps **countries, cities and companies** track progress towards their climate goals.
- GHG Protocol establishes frameworks to measure and manage greenhouse gas (GHG) emissions from private and public sector operations, value chains and mitigation actions.
- GHG Protocol arose when **World Resources Institute (WRI)** and **World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD)** recognized the need for an international standard for corporate GHG accounting and reporting in the late 1990s.

Arctic Council

- Arctic Council is an intergovernmental forum promoting cooperation, coordination and interaction among the Arctic states, Arctic Indigenous communities and other Arctic inhabitants on common Arctic issues, in particular on issues of sustainable development and environmental protection in the Arctic.
- The Arctic Council consists of the eight Arctic States: Canada, the Kingdom of Denmark (including Greenland and the Faroe Islands), Finland, Iceland, Norway, Russia, Sweden and the United States.
- Done already : CURD- FINS

Santiago Network

- The vision of the Santiago Network is to catalyze the **technical assistance of relevant organizations**, bodies, networks and experts, for the implementation of relevant approaches for averting, minimize and addressing **Loss and Damage** at the local, national and regional level, in developing countries that are particularly vulnerable to the adverse effects of climate change.
- The Santiago Network will connect vulnerable developing countries with providers of technical assistance, knowledge, resources they need to address climate risks comprehensively in the context of averting, minimizing and addressing loss and damage.
- Mandated at **COP 25 in Madrid**, the Santiago Network will further the work of the Warsaw International Mechanism for Loss and Damage.

Santiago Network

- The Warsaw International Mechanism for Loss and Damage Associated with Climate Change Impacts was established at the 19th session of the Conference of the Parties to the UNFCCC (COP 19) in 2013.
- It was mandated to enhance knowledge, strengthen dialogue and coordination, and enhance action to address loss and damage associated with the impacts of climate change in vulnerable developing countries.
- No actual money only Bol - Bachchan

- **Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC)**
- The IPCC, the UN body for assessing the science related to climate change.
- It was established by the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) and the World Meteorological Organization (WMO) in 1988.
- The IPCC produces reports that support the UNFCCC.
- IPCC reports cover all relevant information to understand the risk of human-induced climate change, its potential impacts & options for adaptation and mitigation.
- The IPCC does not carry out its own original research. Thousands of scientists and other experts contribute on a voluntary basis.

- AR1 : 1990 : Formed the basis of UNFCCC, 1992
- AR2 : 1995 : Formed the basis of Kyoto Protocol
- AR3 : 2001
- AR4 : 2007 : IPCC won the Nobel Peace Prize
- AR5 : 2014 : Formed the basis of the paris agreement
- AR6 : Currently being published : will inform the global stocktake in 2023.

Reports in News



- The work is shared among three Working Groups (WG), a Task Force and a Task Group of IPCC:
- **WG I** aims at assessing the **physical scientific basis of the climate system** and climate change.
- **WG II** assesses the **vulnerability of socio-economic** and natural systems to climate change.
- **WG III** focuses on climate change **mitigation**, assessing methods for reducing GHG emissions, and removing greenhouse gases from the atmosphere.
- The research by the WGs is published by the IPCC at regular intervals as comprehensive Assessment Reports for the understanding of **human-induced climate change**, potential impacts and options for mitigation and adaptation.

Reports in News



- The IPCC is currently in its 6th Assessment Cycle, during which the IPCC will produce the following reports:
- Assessment reports (ARs) of its three WGs,
- Three special reports (SR1.5, SRCCL & SROCC),
- Special Reports on Global Warming of 1.5 °C (SR1.5 – October 2018)
- Special Report on Climate Change and Land (SRCCL – August 2019)
- Special Report on the Ocean and Cryosphere in a Changing Climate (SROCC – September 2019)
- A refinement to the methodology report, and
- The Synthesis report (the last of the AR6 reports) to inform the global stocktake.

Reports in News



- Aug 2021: The WG I contribution to the AR6, Climate Change 2021: The Physical Science Basis.
- Feb 2022: The WG II to the AR6, Climate Change 2022: Impacts, Adaptation and Vulnerability.
- Apr 2022: The WG III to the AR6, Climate Change 2022: Mitigation of Climate Change.
- The Synthesis Report , the last of the AR6 reports was released recently

Reports in News



- **Few unique points highlighted by the reports:**
- Concentrations of CO₂ unmatched for at least **2 million years.**
- Glacial retreat unmatched for 2,000+ years.
- Sea level rise faster than any prior century for 3,000 years.
- Summer Arctic ice coverage smaller than smaller than any time in the last **1,000 years.**
- **Ocean warming** accounted for **91%** of the heating in the climate system, with land warming, ice loss and atmospheric warming accounting for about 5%, 3% and 1%, respectively.

Reports in News



- India- Both annual and summer monsoon precipitation will increase during the 21st century, with enhanced interannual variability.
- Covered areas and snow volumes will decrease in most regions of the Hindu Kush Himalaya during the 21st century

Reports in News



Reports	Released by
State of Global Climate Report	World Meteorological Organization (WMO)
Global Ocean Observing System (GOOS) Report Card, 2022	World Meteorological Organization (WMO) + Intergovernmental Oceanographic Commission of UNESCO
Greenhouse Gas Bulletin, 2022	World Meteorological Organization (WMO) [Annually]
Climate Investment Opportunities in India's Cooling Sector	World Bank
Climate and Development: An Agenda for Action	World Bank
Nationally Determined Contributions (NDC) Synthesis Report, 2022	UNFCCC
Investing in carbon neutrality: Utopia or the new green wave?	Food and Agriculture Organization + European Bank for Reconstruction and Development

Reports in News



Reports	Released by
State of Climate Action Report	Climate Action Tracker, UN High-Level Climate Change Champions etc
Climate Transparency Report	Climate Transparency
Global Carbon Budget 2022 Report	Global Carbon Project (GCP)
Climate Change Performance Index	Germanwatch, NewClimate Institute and Climate Action Network
Carbon Pricing Leadership Report	Secretariat of Carbon Pricing Leadership Coalition
The World Heritage Glaciers Report	UNESCO+IUCN

International Conventions



- **The UN Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)**
- It is a legally binding multilateral treaty.
- It was opened for signature at the Earth Summit in Rio de Janeiro in 1992 and entered into force in 1993.
- Total members- 196 including India
- **All UN member states — except the United States — have ratified the treaty.**

International Conventions

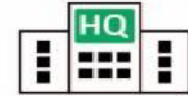


- With a focus on sustainable development, the convention has three main goals:
 - 1) conservation of biological diversity,
 - 2) sustainable utilisation of its benefits/components, and
 - 3) fair and equitable sharing of benefits arising from genetic resources.
- Topmost decision making body of CBD : Conference of Parties to CBD.



Convention on
Biological Diversity

United Nations Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)



Montreal, Canada



Genesis: An international legally binding multilateral treaty, opened for signature in 1992 at the Rio "Earth Summit".



Objective:

- ⇒ Conservation of biological diversity.
- ⇒ Sustainable use of the components of biological diversity.
- ⇒ Fair and equitable sharing of the benefits arising out of the utilization of genetic resources.



Signatories: 196 parties.



Other key information:

- ⇒ Conference of the Parties (COP) is the governing body of the Convention which meets every two years, or as needed.
- ⇒ At COP10, governments agreed to the **Strategic Plan for Biodiversity 2011-2020** and its **Aichi Biodiversity Targets**.
- ⇒ Has 3 Supplementary agreements: **Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety**; **Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit-sharing**; **Nagoya – Kuala Lumpur Supplementary Protocol on Liability and Redress to the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety**.
- ⇒ United Nations General Assembly declared the period **2011-2020** to be the “**United Nations Decade on Biodiversity**”.

International Conventions



- **India and Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD)**
- India is a party to the Convention. India ratified it in 1994.
- The Biological Diversity Act, 2002 was enacted for giving effect to the provisions of the Convention.
- To implement the provisions of the Act, the government established the National Biodiversity Authority (NBA) in 2003.
- State Biodiversity Authority, Biodiversity Management Committees at local levels have also been established.
- People's Biodiversity Register (PBR) which is a record of knowledge, perception and attitude of people about natural resources, plants and animals, their utilization and conservation in a village or a panchayat is also being prepared.

- **Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety**
- The Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety to the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) is an international agreement adopted in 2000.
- It entered into force in 2003 and covers the field of biotechnology.
- It currently has 173 parties.
- India has ratified CBD and its Cartagena Protocol (signed in Cartagena, Colombia).
- Cartagena Protocol aims to ensure the safe handling, transport, and use of living modified organisms (LMOs) resulting from modern biotechnology.
- LMOs have novel combination of genetic material.
- Remember : CART : Transport

International Conventions



- The Cartagena Protocol chiefly governs the following:
- LMOs that are intentionally introduced into the environment (trees, seeds or fish).
- Genetically modified (GM) farm commodities (grain and corn used for animal feed, food or for processing).
- LMOs are classified as the following under the Protocol:
- LMOs for intentional introduction into the environment – subject to AIA procedures.
- LMOs for direct usage as food or feed, or for processing – subject to simplified procedures which include informing through the BCH.
- LMOs for contained usage (like bacteria for lab experiments) – these are exempt from AIA procedures.

International Conventions



- The Protocol has provisions for an Advance Informed Agreement (AIA) procedure.
- The AIA is for ensuring that countries are given enough information to make informed decisions before agreeing to import LMOs into their country.
- There are **four components** to the AIA:
- Notification by the exporter (This is a detailed written description of the LMO by the exporter, well in advance of the first shipment)
- Acknowledgement of notification receipt by the importer
- Decision procedure (Approve/prohibit/ask for more information, etc.)
- Review of decisions
- Data will be shared regarding scientific risks etc.

International Conventions



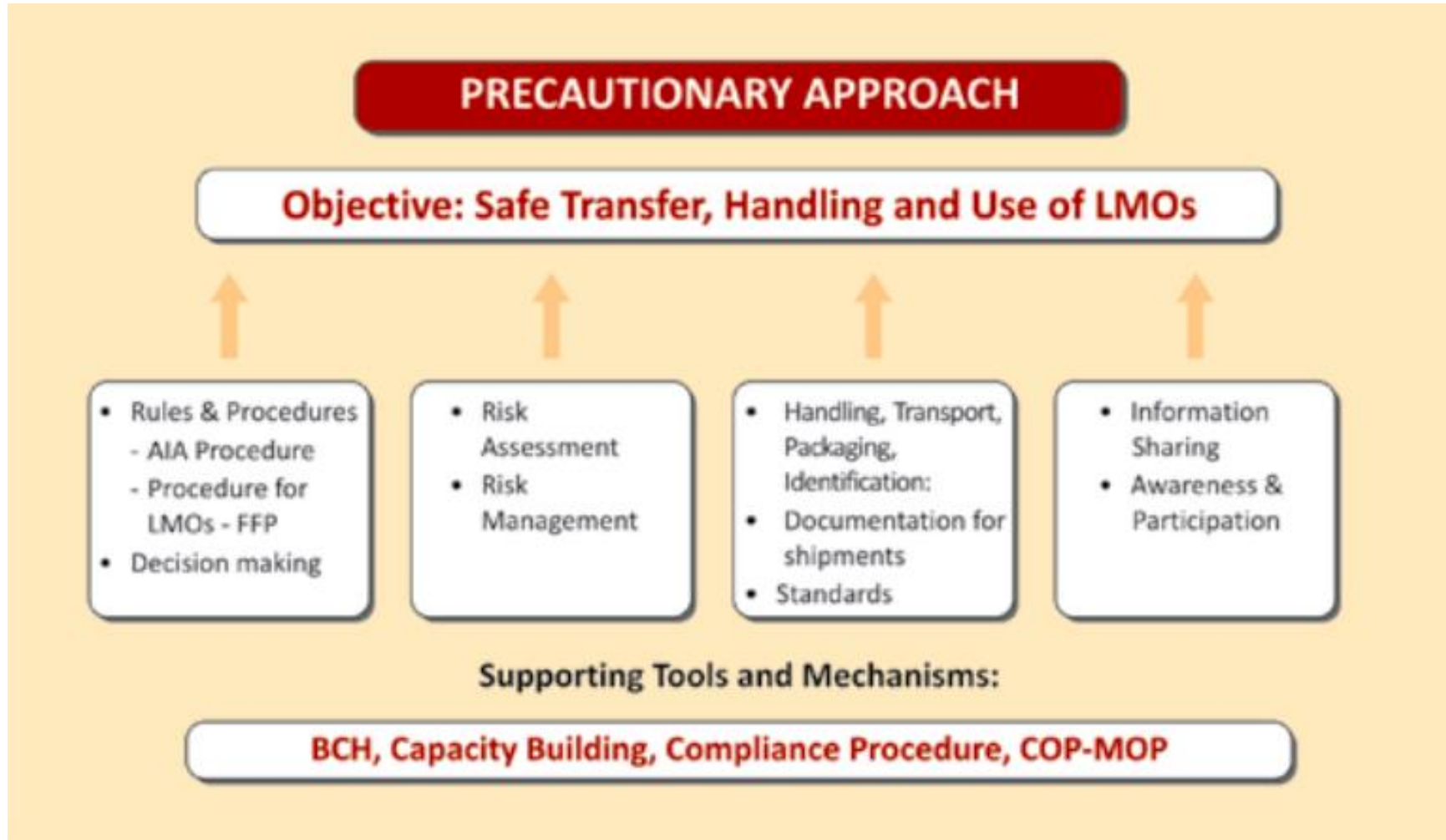
- The Cartagena Protocol also sets up a Biosafety Clearing-House (BCH) to enable information exchange on LMOs between countries.
- It is also intended to help countries implement the Cartagena Protocol.
- The BCH is an information-sharing mechanism for relevant technical, scientific and legal information.
- The Protocol gives a precautionary approach to the issue of transfer of LMOs from one country to another.

International Conventions



- LMOs for Food/ Feed / Processing :
- Such LMOs relevant information and risk assessment to be made publicly available through Biosafety clearing house.
- It does not cover pharmaceuticals for humans addressed by other international agreements and organisations or products derived from LMOs, such as cooking oil from GM corn.

International Conventions



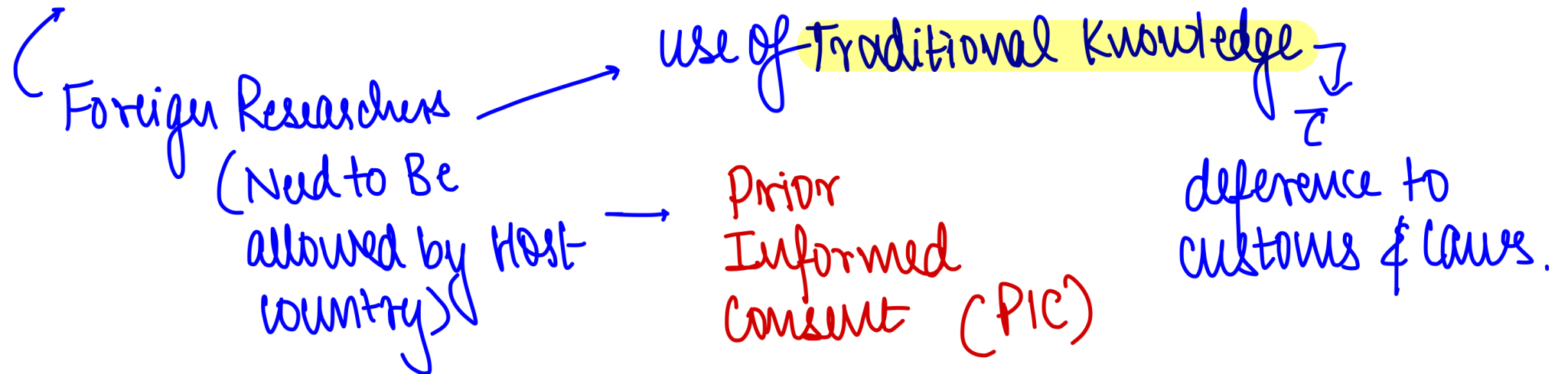
- **India and Cartagena Protocol**
- India is a party to the Cartagena Protocol (ratified in 2003).
- The nodal agency (Competent National Authority-CNA) in the country for the implementation of the Protocol is the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change (MOEF&CC)
- Regarding setting up of procedures for regulating LMOs, India was one of the early movers in the development of a biosafety regulatory framework, way back in 1989, and has a systematic and structured science-based regulatory system.
- In the Indian regulations, the terms Genetically Engineered Organism or Genetically Modified Organism are used, which are synonymous with LMOs.
- In India, series of guidelines are available for risk assessment and risk management of GMOs

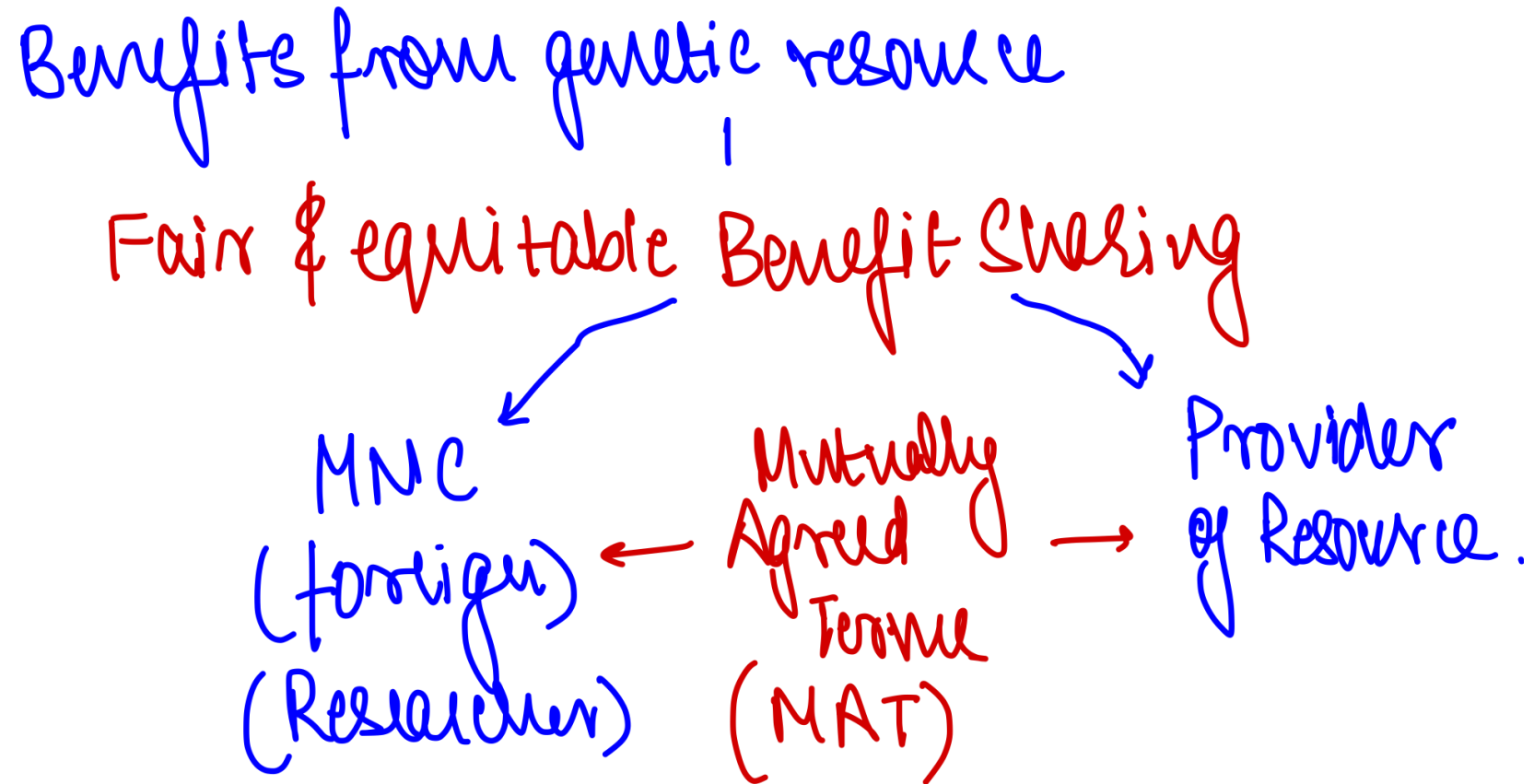
- **Nagoya-Kuala Lumpur Supplementary Protocol**
- The Nagoya-Kuala Lumpur Supplementary Protocol on Liability and Redress is a supplementary protocol to the Cartagena protocol on Biosafety.
- After several years of negotiations, the Parties to the Cartagena Protocol on Biosafety adopted the Supplementary Protocol on 15 October 2010, in Nagoya, Japan
- The Supplementary Protocol requires that response measures are taken in the event of damage resulting from living modified organisms, or where there is sufficient likelihood that damage will result if timely response measures are not taken.
- The Supplementary Protocol also includes provisions in relation to civil liability.

- **Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit-sharing : 3rd objective**
- At the 10th Conference of Parties (COP10 2010) to the Convention on Biological Diversity in Nagoya, Japan, the Nagoya Protocol was adopted.
- It is the second Protocol (supplementary agreement) to the CBD. It entered into force in 2014.
- It presently has 137 parties, including India.
- India signed the Nagoya Protocol in 2011 and ratified it in October 2012. The ratification by India was done at the 11th Conference of Parties (COP) to the CBD, which was conducted in Hyderabad.
- Nagoya Protocol is about “Access to Genetic Resources and the Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits Arising from their Utilization”, one of the three objectives of the CBD.

International Conventions

country has rights (sovereign) on genetic resource in its borders





- **The parties to the protocol are obliged to take actions with respect to access to genetic resources, benefit-sharing, and compliance.**
- **Access to Genetic Resources**
- Access measures should have legal certainty, transparency, and clarity.
- The rules and procedures thereof should be fair and non-arbitrary.
- There should be clear rules for prior informed consent and mutually agreed to terms.
- The rules should have provisions for the issuance of a permit (or its equivalent) when granted access.
- Encourage research that will contribute to the conservation of biodiversity and its sustainable use.

International Conventions



- Cases of imminent emergencies that threaten plant, animal, or human health should be considered.
- Take into consideration the importance of genetic resources for food and agriculture, to have food security.

- **Benefit-sharing**
- Benefit-sharing measures should have provisions for the fair & equitable sharing of benefits that arise from the utilization of genetic resources with the contracting party that provides genetic resources.
- Utilization implies R&D on the biochemical or genetic composition of genetic resources, and also resultant applications & commercialization.
- Both Monetary and non monetary, commercial and non commercial uses are covered.
- Sharing should be subject to mutually-agreed terms.
- Benefits could be non-monetary or monetary. Benefits could be in the form of royalties and/or sharing of the results of the research.

International Conventions



- **Compliance**
- This includes having legal provisions for the implementation of the protocol.
- This also includes having dispute resolution mechanisms in place for resolving any disputes.

International Conventions



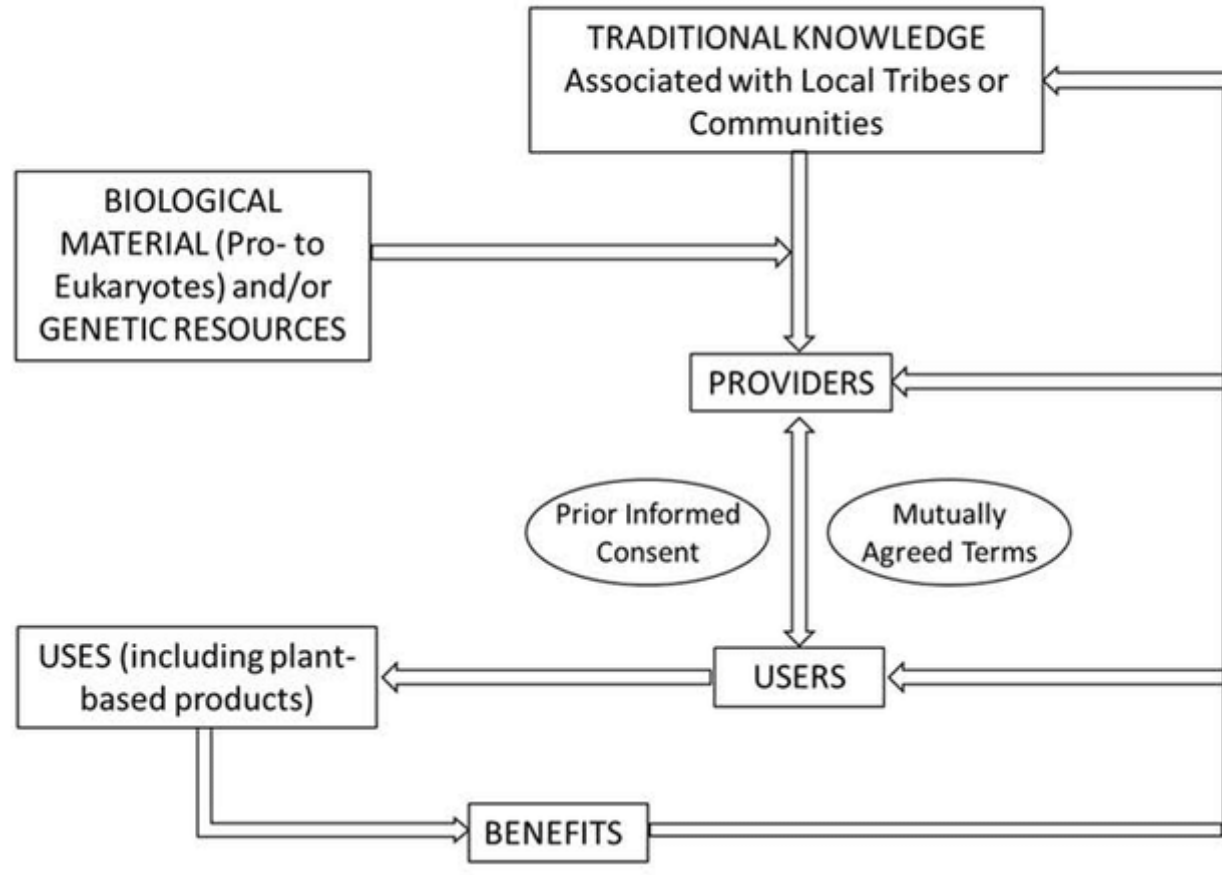
- The country must translate the provisions into domestic legislations to ensure legal certainty.
- There are official checkpoints in terms of PIC and MAT.
- India : Biodiversity Act, 2002 to ensure compliance to the CBD and its additional protocols.

International Conventions

Nagoya Protocol on Access and Benefit Sharing



ACCESS TO BIOLOGICAL
/GENETIC RESOURCES
AND THE FAIR AND
EQUITABLE SHARING
OF BENEFITS
ACCRUING FROM THE
COMMERCIAL USE
UNDER CONVENTION
ON BIOLOGICAL
DIVERSITY



- **International Treaty on Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (PGRFA)**
- PGRFA is popularly known as the International Seed Treaty. It is an international agreement in harmony with CBD.
- It aims at guaranteeing food security through the conservation, exchange, and sustainable use of the world's plant genetic resources for food and agriculture, as well as the fair and equitable benefit sharing arising from its use.
- **Context**
- India hosted the Ninth Session of the Governing Body (GB9) of the International Treaty on Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (ITPGRFA).

International Conventions



The International Treaty
ON PLANT GENETIC RESOURCES
FOR FOOD AND AGRICULTURE

International Treaty on Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (ITPGRFA)



Genesis: A legally binding agreement that was adopted by 31st session of Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) in 2001 and entered into force in 2004.



Objective:

- Recognizing the enormous contribution of farmers to the diversity of crops that feed the world.
- Establishing a global system to provide farmers, plant breeders and scientists with access to plant genetic materials.
- Ensuring that recipients share benefits they derive from the use of these genetic materials with the countries where they have been originated.



Membership: 150 Contracting Parties including one member organization



Other key information:

- Also known as seed treaty.
- Provided international legal framework needed for establishment of Svalbard Global Seed Vault in Norway.
- Funding for the treaty comes from its Contracting Parties and from Food and Agriculture Organization.



About Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture (PGRFA)

- Any plant materials, such as seeds, fruits, cuttings, pollen, and other organs and tissues from which plants can be grown.
- Include **traditional crop varieties and their wild relatives**, modern cultivars, breeding lines etc. which provide food, feed for domestic animals, fibre, clothing, shelter, medicine and energy.
- **National Bureau of Plant Genetic Resources (NBPGR)**, established in 1976, is the nodal organisation in India for planning, conducting, promoting, coordinating and lending all activities concerning plant.
- Threats to PGRFA conservation and utilization: Population growth and urbanization; pollution; climate change; invasive alien species; genetic vulnerability and erosion; etc.

International Conventions



- **Major decisions taken at GB9**
- Historical first: Federation of Seed Industry of India (FSII) contributed Rs 20 lakhs to the Benefit-Sharing Fund (BSF).
- India appointed as Co-Chair of the Working Group on Enhancement of Multilateral System of Access and Benefit-sharing (MLS).
- Consensus on implementation of Farmers Rights reached.
- GB9 considered the options for encouraging, guiding and promoting the realization of Farmers' Rights.

BENEFIT-SHARING FUND (BSF)

- It supports **agricultural projects for farmers, public institutions and others in developing countries** to conserve and use PGRFA to improve food crop production, fight plant pests and adopt to the effects of climate change
- BSF supports **projects involving smallholder farmers and local communities.**

- Contracting Parties acknowledged the intervention made by India, and supported by many African nations, regarding effect due to institutional reform within the CGAIR system (a global research partnership for a food-secure future) on funding of gene-banks globally.
- Decisions deferred for later: Issues like the **multilateral system (MLS)** of access and benefit sharing (ABS) and **digital sequence information (DSI)**.
- **Multilateral system (MLS) of access and benefit sharing (ABS)**- MLS refers to global system that enables countries to exchange much-needed plant genetic material with one another.
- The benefit sharing includes financial and non-financial support of PGRFA conservation activities around the world.

- **Digital Sequencing Information**- Data derived from or linked to genetic resources. Placeholder term for genetic information, bioinformation, sequence information, natural information, genetic sequence data, nucleotide sequence data or genetic resources.
- Help in developing vaccines, regulating invasive species, ecosystem research etc

- **Aichi Biodiversity Targets**
- At CBD COP 12 (2014), parties discussed the implementation of the Strategic Plan for Biodiversity 2011- 2020 & its Aichi Biodiversity Targets — to be achieved before 2020.
- Officially known as “Strategic Plan for Biodiversity 2011-2020”, it provided a set of 20 ambitious yet achievable targets collectively.
- Aichi Targets in India : India agreed to form the National Biodiversity action plan with 12 targets, similar to the aichi targets.

International Conventions

Mainstreaming	Sustainable use	Protect biodiversity	Benefits to all	Enhance implementation
 1 Understand values	 5 Halve rate of loss	 11 Protected areas	 14 Restore ecosystems	 17 Revise NBSAPs
 2 Mainstream biodiversity	 6 Sustainable fisheries	 12 Prevent extinctions	 15 Enhance resilience	 18 Respect traditional knowledge
 3 Address incentives	 7 Manage within limits	 13 Conserve gene pool	 16 Implement Nagoya Prot.	 19 Improve knowledge
 4 Sustainable production	 8 Reduce pollution			 20 Mobilize resources
	 9 Reduce invasive species			
	 10 Minimize reef loss			

- None of the 20 ‘Aichi Biodiversity Targets’ agreed on by national governments through the CBD has been met, according to CBD’s Global Biodiversity Outlook 5 report.
- **Sharm El Sheikh Declaration – New Deal for Nature**
- COP 14 of CBD adopted this declaration in Sharm El city (also called the city of peace) in Egypt.
- It focuses on integrating biodiversity into legislative & policy frameworks.
- It aims to develop a Post-2020 Global Biodiversity Framework (after failed Aichi Biodiversity Targets) to achieve the 2050 vision for biodiversity known as **New Deal for Nature**- catalyse action from all stakeholders in support of biodiversity conservation.

International Conventions



- **COP 15**
- The 15th Conference of Parties (COP15) of the Convention on Biological Diversity recently concluded in Montreal, Canada.
- **About COP15**
- Chaired by China and hosted by Canada.
- Held in **two phases**:
- Phase **one** took place virtually in **Kunming**, China, in October 2021
- Phase **two** was recently held in **Montreal, Canada**.
- Objective: To adopt a **Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF)**, which will replace the Aichi Biodiversity Targets that expired in 2020.
- GBF and its underlying documents are **not legally binding**.

International Conventions



- Adoption of Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework (GBF) to address biodiversity loss, restore ecosystems and protect indigenous rights, with:
- **4 long-term** goals for **2050** related to the 2050 Vision for Biodiversity
- **23 action-oriented** global targets for urgent action over the decade to **2030**.

International Conventions

Kunming-Montreal Global Goals for 2050



Goal A

Halting human-induced extinction of threatened species and reducing the rate of extinction of all species tenfold by 2050.



Goal B

Sustainable use and management of biodiversity to ensure that nature's contributions to people are valued, maintained and enhanced.



Goal C

Fair sharing of the benefits from the utilization of genetic resources, and digital sequence information on genetic resources.



Goal D

Adequate means of implementing the GBF be accessible to all Parties, particularly Least Developed Countries and Small Island Developing States.



Decoding the 23 targets set at COP15

A total of 196 countries have signed a historic deal to protect 30% of the world for nature by 2030 in Montreal

REDUCING THREATS TO BIODIVERSITY

- 1) **Halting biodiversity loss:** Bringing the loss of areas of high biodiversity importance close to zero, while respecting the rights of indigenous people
- 2) **Effective restoration:** At least 30% of areas of degraded terrestrial, inland water, and coastal and marine ecosystems are under effective restoration
- 3) **Mapping linkages:** Sustainable use of above areas is consistent with conservation outcomes
- 4) **Saving endangered species:** Urgent steps to halt human induced extinction of threatened species; maintain their diversity through in situ and ex situ conservation
- 5) **Protecting wild species:** Sustainable, safe and legal use of wild species; preventing overexploitation
- 6) **Invasive alien species:** Mitigating their impacts by reducing rates of introduction by 50%; controlling them in priority sites such as islands
- 7) **Tackling pollution:** Reduce pollution risks to levels that are not harmful to biodiversity and ecosystem functions
- 8) **Climate crisis:** Minimise impact of climate change and ocean acidification through nature-based solutions



Monitored wildlife populations have seen a 69% drop on average since '70, say WWF, LPF

MEETING HUMAN REQUIREMENTS THROUGH SUSTAINABLE USE

- 9) **Serving humans:** Ensure use of wild species yields benefits for humans, especially for those most dependent on biodiversity
- 10) **Ecosystem productivity:** Sustainable management of areas under agriculture, aquaculture, fisheries and forestry for resilience and long-term productivity
- 11) **Handling nature's contributions:** Restore, maintain and enhance nature's contributions to people through regulation of air, water, and climate
- 12) **Biodiversity in urban fabric:** Increase the area and quality and connectivity of, access to, and benefits from green and blue spaces in urban and densely populated areas
- 13) **Sharing genetic resources:** Take effective legal, policy, administrative and capacity-building measures to ensure equal sharing of benefits of genetic resources



Indigenous rights have been included in one-third of the new framework's targets

TOOLS AND SOLUTIONS FOR IMPLEMENTATION AND MAINSTREAMING

- 14) **Policy-making:** Integration of biodiversity and its values into policies across all levels of govt, other sectors
- 15) **Legal perils for businesses:** Regular assessments by transnational firms of their risks, dependencies, impacts on biodiversity; report on compliance with regulations
- 16) **Making eco-friendly choices:** Encouraging people to make sustainable consumption choices, reduce global footprint of consumption
- 17) **Biosecurity measures:** Adopting such steps for handling of biotechnology and distribution of its benefits
- 18) **Removal of harmful incentives:** Identify by 2025, and eliminate/reform incentives harmful for biodiversity; cut them by \$500 bn per year by 2030
- 19) **Biodiversity finance:** Increasing financial resources, mobilising \$200 billion per year by 2030
- 20) **Technical cooperation:** Strengthen capacity-building and development, access to and transfer of technology
- 21) **Sharing knowledge:** Access to information by decision makers, practitioners and public; access to technologies of indigenous peoples only with their consent
- 22) **Equal representation:** Ensuring equitable representation in decision-making
- 23) **Gender based review:** A gender-responsive approach by recognising women's rights and access to natural resources



Signatories aim to ensure \$200bn per year is channelled to conservation initiatives

International Conventions



- 30x30 target explained
- Target 3 calls for 30 percent of the world's terrestrial, inland water, and of coastal and marine areas, to be in effective protection and management by 2030.
- For this, a high ambition coalition was setup (intergovernmental group co chaired by Costa Rica and France and by UK as co chair, championing a global deal for 30x 30.
- India is part of this High Ambition Coalition.

International Conventions



- Global Environment Facility requested to establish a **Special Trust Fund in 2023**, and until 2030, to support the implementation of the GBF.
- Fund would have its own **“equitable governing body”** dedicated to achieving the goals of the GBF and must be prepared to receive **“financing from all sources”**, including official development assistance
- Set clear indicators to measure progress to form an agreed synchronized and cyclical system based on **National biodiversity strategies and action plans (NBSAPs)**, National reports, Global review of collective progress, Voluntary peer reviews etc.
- Revised or updated NBSAPs in alignment with the Kunming-Montreal global biodiversity framework and its goals and targets to be communicated in a standardized format by COP-16 in Turkey in 2024.

International Conventions



- Parties should submit **national reports** containing agreed headline indicators in **2026** and **2029**.
- Multilateral mechanism for **benefit-sharing** from the use of digital sequence information on **genetic resources**: This may include innovative revenue generation measures and a global fund within GBF.
- Adoption of the **Gender Plan of Action** to support and promote the gender-responsive implementation of the GBF and its associated mechanisms.

International Conventions



- Events alongside COP 15
- **World Restoration Flagships**
- Context- The UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration declared first **10 World Restoration Flagships** at the side-lines of COP15 of CBD.
- For honouring the best examples of large-scale and long-term ecosystem restoration in any country or region, embodying the 10 Restoration Principles of the UN Decade.
- Initiatives eligible to receive United Nations-backed promotion, advice or funding.

- Progress of all Flagships to be transparently monitored through the **Framework for Ecosystem Restoration Monitoring**, the UN Decade's platform for keeping track of global restoration efforts.
- First 10 Flagships stretch across 23 countries and all ecosystems.
- Together aim to restore more than 60 million hectares and create more than 13 million jobs.
- Flagship Initiatives Selection Criteria
- Clearly identifiable geographically.
- Part of nominated area already under successful, measurable, and well-documented restoration.
- Well-defined ecological, cultural, and socio-economic objectives and goals.

TEN PRINCIPLES THAT UNDERPIN ECOSYSTEM RESTORATION



GLOBAL
CONTRIBUTION



BROAD
ENGAGEMENT



MANY TYPES
OF ACTIVITIES



BENEFITS TO
NATURE AND PEOPLE



ADDRESSES CAUSES
OF DEGRADATION



KNOWLEDGE
INTEGRATION



MEASURABLE
GOALS



LOCAL AND LAND/
SEASCAPE CONTEXTS



MONITORING
AND MANAGEMENT



POLICY
INTEGRATION

About the UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration

- 2021 to 2030 has been declared by the United Nations General Assembly as the UN Decade on Ecosystem Restoration.
- Led by: UN Environment Programme and the Food and Agriculture Organization of the UN, together with the support of partners.
- Aim: To prevent, halt, and reverse the loss and degradation of ecosystems worldwide and revive billions of hectares, covering terrestrial as well as aquatic ecosystems.

International Conventions



Flagship Initiative	Countries	Aim
Trinational Atlantic Forest Pact	Argentina, Brazil, Paraguay	To mend South America's iconic Atlantic Forest and restoring 15 million ha of degraded forest by 2050.
Abu Dhabi Marine Restoration	United Arab Emirates	To restore coral, mangrove and seagrass in Abu Dhabi, creating a refuge for the dugong, a fast-disappearing aquatic mammal.
Great Green Wall for Restoration and Peace	Burkina Faso, Djibouti, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Mali, Mauritania, Niger, Senegal, Sudan, Chad	To restore savanna, grasslands and farmlands across an 8,000km belt of Africa known as the Sahel.

International Conventions



Flagship Initiative	Countries	Aim
Namami Gange	India	To rejuvenate India's sacred Ganges River and surrounding basin and restore people's connection to the river, while reducing pollution and reversing deforestation.
Multi-country Mountain Flagship	Democratic Republic of the Congo, Kyrgyzstan, Rwanda, Serbia, Uganda	To protect mountain landscapes in Kyrgyzstan, Rwanda, Serbia and Uganda and to safeguard a range of imperiled species, including mountain gorillas and snow leopards
Small Island Developing States	Vanuatu, Comoros, Saint Lucia	To restore sensitive ecosystems in Vanuatu, St. Lucia and Comoros and help the island nations safeguard wildlife, brace for climate change and strengthen their economies.

International Conventions



Flagship Initiative	Countries	Aim
Atlyn Dala Conservation Initiative	Kazakhstan	To conserve and restore Kazakhstan's steppe, semi-desert and desert ecosystems across the historical range of the Saiga antelope
Central American Dry Corridor	Costa Rica, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Nicaragua, Panama	To restore 300,000 ha of drought-stricken Central American farmland and forests.
Building with Nature in Indonesia	Indonesia	To naturally regenerate mangroves and protect Indonesia's coast against flooding
Shan-Shui Initiative in China	China	To restore 10 million hectares of ecosystems across China, including forests, grasslands and waterways.

Restoration Barometer report

- **Context**
- The **International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN)** launched its **first** Restoration Barometer Report at COP 15
- Restoration Barometer was launched in 2016 as the Bonn Challenge Barometer.
- Tracks restoration progress **across terrestrial ecosystems** including coastal and inland waters where use or management rights can be identified (i.e., not high seas).
- Has **8 indicators** that build a comprehensive picture of a country's restoration progress and progress towards global goals.

International Conventions



- Currently, **22 countries** are using the Barometer to report the progress of their restoration targets and more than 50 have endorsed it.
- **Findings of 2022 report:**
- Financial investments of \$26 billion across 18 countries.
- 14 million hectares of degraded landscapes.
- Data from Ecuador, India, Pakistan, and Uzbekistan is being finalized and will be published later.

International Conventions

Global goals tracked by Restoration Barometer

01



The Bonn Challenge

02



The 30x30 target under the
Post-2020 Global Biodiversity
Framework

03



The Paris Agreement

04



The Land Degradation
Neutrality Target

05



1 trillion Trees

High Seas Treaty



- **High Seas Treaty**
- High seas are open ocean areas that are outside the jurisdiction of any country—the reason why the treaty is commonly known as the agreement on “biodiversity beyond national jurisdictions”, or BBNJ.
- It will regulate all human activities in the high seas with the objective of ensuring that ocean resources, including biodiversity, are utilised in a sustainable manner, and their benefits are shared equitably among countries
- The high seas comprise 64 percent of the ocean surface, and about 43 per cent of the Earth.
- These areas are home to about 2.2 million marine species and upto a trillion different kinds of microorganism.

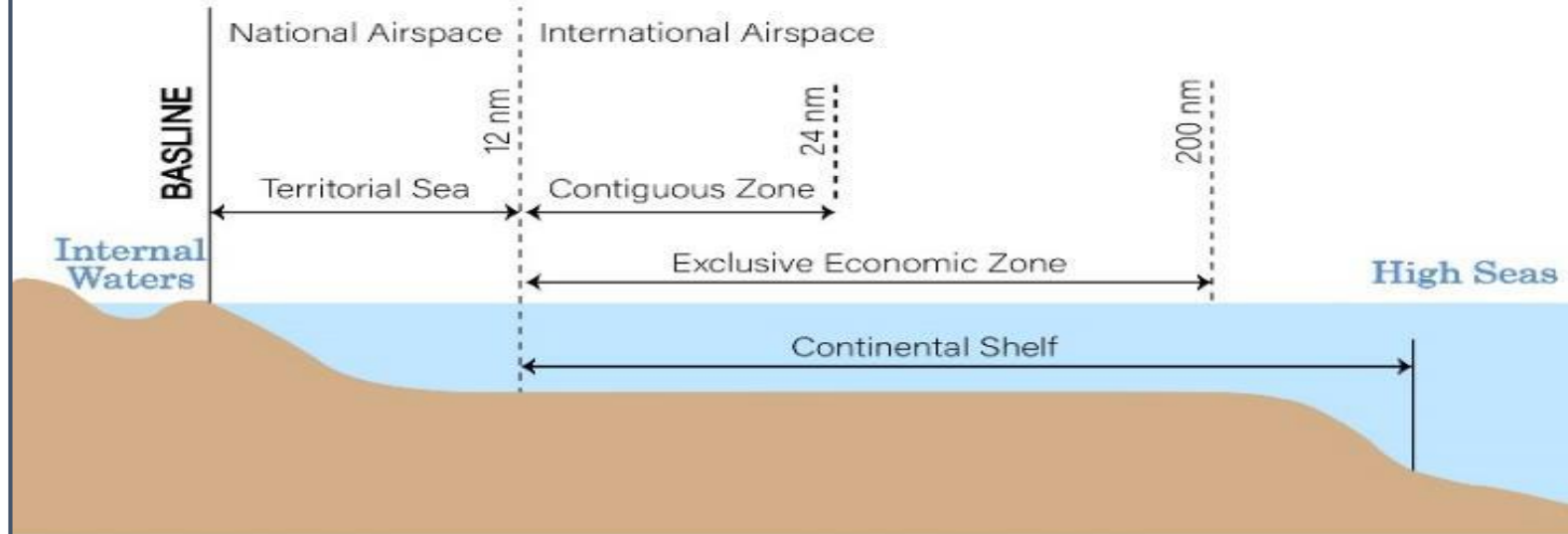
High Seas Treaty



- **Treaty has been concluded, but it has not entered into force yet.**
- Think : When will it enter into force?

High Seas Treaty

U. N. CONVENTION ON THE LAW OF THE SEA: DEFINED WATERS



MARITIME BOUNDARY DEFINITIONS

Territorial Sea. Sovereign territory of the state. Foreign civilian and military vessels have right to innocent passage.

Contiguous Zone. State may exercise control necessary to prevent infringement of its customs, fiscal, immigration, or sanitary laws.

Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ). Sovereign rights for exploring and exploiting resources, preserving marine environment, establishing artificial islands and structures.

High Seas. All parts of the sea that are not included in the EEZ, the territorial sea, or in the internal waters of a state. No exclusive rights.

High Seas Treaty



- The High Seas Treaty will work as an implementation agreement under the The United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS), much like the Paris Agreement works under the UNFCCC
- The High Seas Treaty has four main objectives:
- Demarcation of marine protected areas (MPAs), rather like there are protected forests or wildlife areas;
- Sustainable use of marine genetic resources and equitable sharing of benefits arising from them;
- Initiation of the practice of environmental impact assessments for all major activities in the oceans
- Capacity building and technology transfer

High Seas Treaty

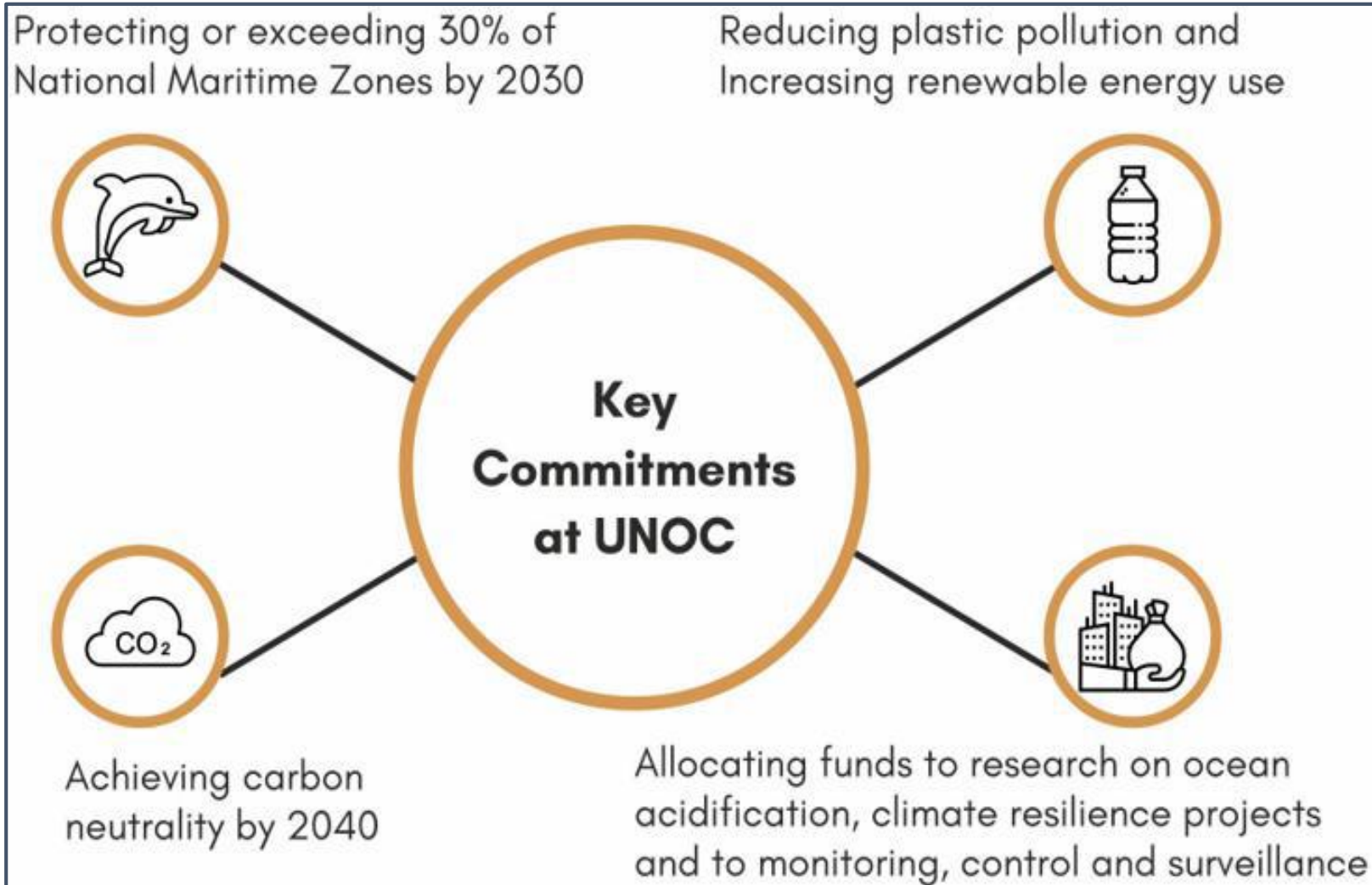


- Active recall : WTO agreement in recent meeting?
- The treaty is the result of more than 20 years of protracted negotiations. The details of all the major contentious provisions, including environmental impact assessments, sharing of benefits from genetic resources, and mobilisation of funds for conservation activities, are still to be worked out. Many issues remain unaddressed, including the mechanisms for policing the protected areas, the fate of the projects that are assessed to be heavily polluting, and the resolution of disputes.

- **Context**
- The second UNOC, co-hosted by Kenya and Portugal at Lisbon, ended with the Lisbon Declaration, a political declaration entitled ‘Our Ocean, Our Future: call for action’.
- **About UNOC**
- First UNOC was held in 2017 at UN Headquarters in New York, co-hosted by the Governments of Fiji and Sweden.
- **Key Highlights of second UNOOC**
- India was a participant and committed to a Coastal Clean Seas Campaign and will work toward a ban on single use plastics.

- Over 150 countries collectively agreed to scale up science-based and innovative actions to address ocean emergency, supporting the implementation of **SDG 14 (Life Below Water)**.
- This is in line with the **United Nations Decade of Ocean Science for Sustainable Development (2021- 2030)**.
- Emphasized the particular importance of implementing the Paris Agreement (2015) and Glasgow Climate Pact (2021) to help ensure the health, productivity, sustainable use, and resilience of the ocean.
- States made voluntary commitments to conserve or protect **at least 30% of the global ocean by 2030 within Marine Protected Areas**, and other effective area-based conservation measures.
- UNESCO launched its key State of the Ocean Report (pilot edition) during the event.

UN Ocean Conference



- **Convention on International Trade in Endangered Species of Wild Fauna and Flora (CITES)**
- Also known as the Washington Convention, is an international agreement (multilateral treaty) between governments to ensure that international trade in specimens of wild animals and plants does not threaten their survival.
- It was drafted due to a resolution adopted by members of IUCN in 1963.
- It entered into force in 1975.
- CITES is legally binding on the Parties (184 (including EU)).
- **However, it does not take the place of national laws.**
- It only provides a framework to be respected by each Party. The parties need to adopt their own domestic legislation to ensure that CITES is implemented at the national level.

- **Conference of Parties to CITES (CoP)**
- The CITES CoP (World Wildlife Conference) is where parties convene every two to three years to review and decide on regulating trade in endangered species.
- The CoP will decide on proposals to list, remove, or change species listing on the CITES appendices.
- **The species covered by CITES are listed in three Appendices according to the required degree of protection:**
- **Appendix I** includes species threatened with extinction. Trade in specimens of these species is **permitted only in exceptional circumstances** — like for captive breeding. (Legal international trade of the species does not take for commercial purposes)

- **Appendix II** includes species not necessarily threatened with extinction but in which trade must be **controlled** to avoid utilisation incompatible with their survival. It also includes species that resemble other species and need to be preserved for them.
- **Appendix III** contains species protected in at least one country which has asked other CITES Parties for assistance in controlling the trade.
- At each regular meeting of the CoP, Parties submit proposals to amend Appendices I and II.
- Those amendment proposals are discussed and then submitted for a vote.

CITES Appendices



Appendix I

Includes species threatened with extinction

CITES prohibits international trade in specimens of these species except when purpose of import is not commercial. For instance for scientific research.



Appendix II

Lists species that are **not necessarily now threatened with extinction but that may become so unless trade is closely controlled**

Also includes so-called "look-alike species", i.e. species whose specimens in trade look like those of species listed for conservation reasons

International trade may be **authorized** by the granting of an export permit or re-export certificate.



Appendix III

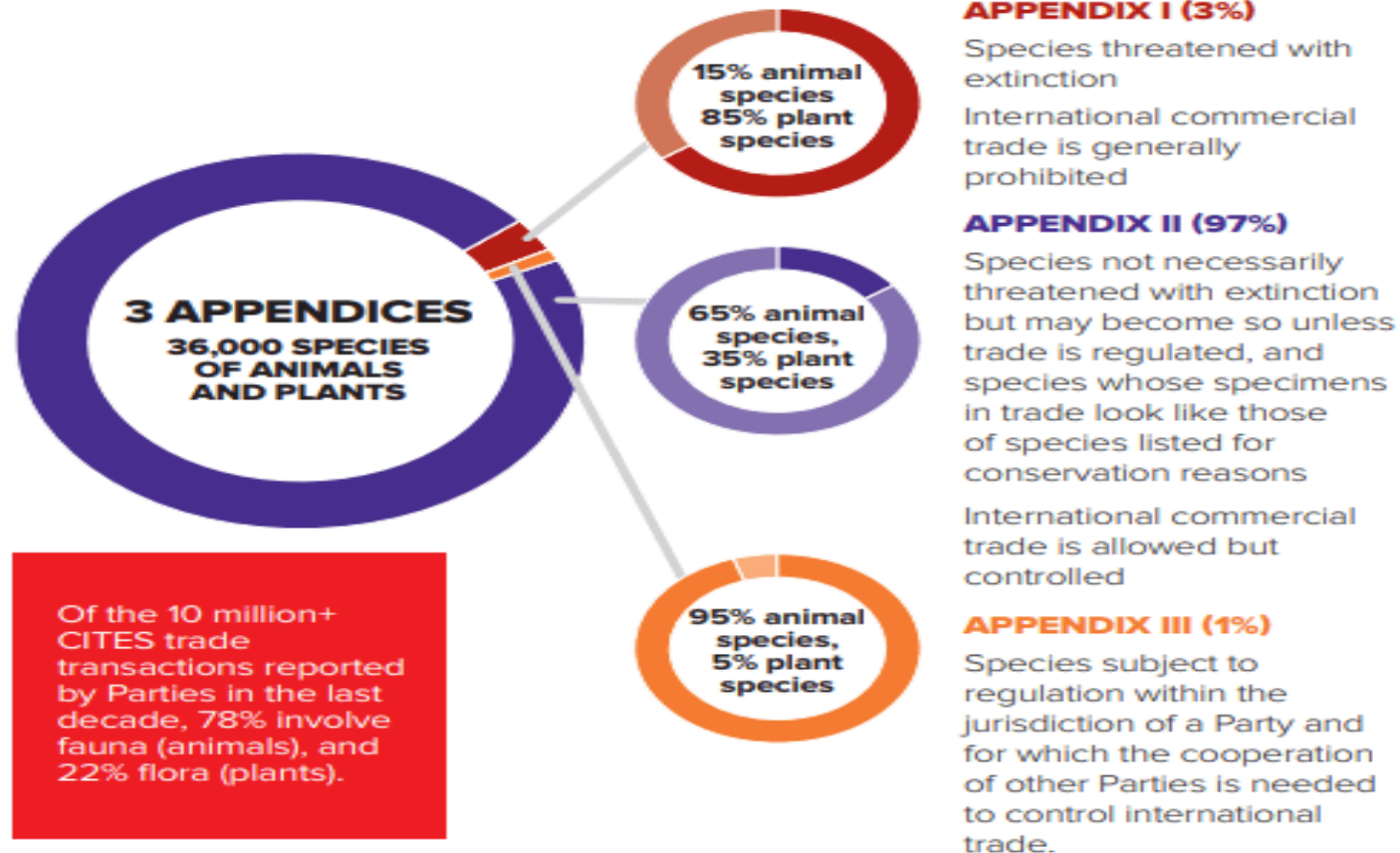
Contains species that are **protected in at least one country, which has asked other CITES Parties for assistance in controlling the trade**

International trade in specimens of species is **allowed** only on presentation of the appropriate permits or certificates.



DIFFERENT DEGREES OF PROTECTION

CITES accords varying degrees of protection to more than 36,000 species of animals and plants by applying different provisions to species included in three Appendices:



- **Functioning of CITES**
- CITES works by subjecting international trade in specimens of selected species to specific controls.
- All import and export of species covered by CITES must be authorised through a **licensing system**.
- Each Party designates one or more **Management Authorities** for administering the licensing system and one or more **Scientific Authorities** to advise them on the effects of trade on the status of the species.
- Recall our discussion wrt to recent amendments to the **Wildlife Protection Act, 2022**.

- Acts regulating International trade in all wildlife species of India (including the species covered under CITES):
- Wild Life (Protection) Act of 1972, Export–Import Policy (EXIM Policy) under the Foreign Trade (Development and Regulation) Act of 1992 and Customs Act of 1962.
- **Management Authority for CITES** (CITES-MA) in India: Director of Wildlife Preservation, Government of India.
- Management authority competent to grant permits : Wildlife Crime Control Bureau.

- Government of India appointed **five Scientific Authorities** to assist the CITES MA on scientific aspects of CITES
- Zoological Survey of India (ZSI), Kolkata.
- Botanical Survey of India (BSI), Kolkata.
- Central Marine Fisheries Research Institute (CMFRI), Cochin.
- Wildlife Institute of India (WII), Dehradun.
- Institute of Forest Genetics and Tree Breeding (IFGTB), Coimbatore.

- **CoP 18**
- In CoP18, held in Geneva, Switzerland, in 2019, India submitted proposals
- to move Smooth-Coated Otter (VU), Small-Clawed Otter (VU), Indian Star Tortoise (VU), Tokay Gecko (LC) and Wedgefish (CR) from Appendix II to Appendix I.
- to remove Indian Rosewood (VU) from Appendix II.
- In 2019, Star tortoise (VU), Asian Small-Clawed (VU) and Smooth-Coated Otters (VU) were moved to Appendix I. A complete ban was enforced on their trade.

- **19th Conference of the Parties to CITES (CoP19)**
- CoP19 was held in Panama in November 2022.
- 52 proposals have been put forward that would affect the regulations on international trade for sharks, reptiles, elephants, turtles, etc.
- Operation Turtshield, India's efforts to curb turtle wildlife crime was acknowledged at CoP19.

- **19th Conference of the Parties to CITES (CoP19)**
- First **World Wildlife Trade Report** was released at the COP19.
- It gave insights into the international trade in animals and plants regulated under the CITES treaty.
- According to the report, majority of CITES-regulated trade involved artificially propagated (for plants) or captive-produced (for animals bred or born in captivity) species.
- **Only 18%** of all trade involved wild-sourced species (which are dominated by plants).

- India's Proposals
- India proposed moving the Red-Crowned Roofed Turtle (*Batagur kachuga* – CR) and Leith's softshell turtle (*Nilssonia leithii* – CR) from Appendix II to I.
- India's proposal to include the Jeypore Ground (Indian) Gecko (EN) in Appendix II was adopted by the members of the CITES Working Group.
- On India's initiative a proposal to clarify the quantity of Shisham (*Dalbergia sissoo*) items such as furniture was considered.

Species in News

- **Jeypore Ground Gecko**
- **Context-** Jeypore Ground Gecko has been included in Appendix II of CITES
- Characteristics:
- Nocturnal, comes out during the evening, after darkness, and forages on ground.
- Threats: Habitat loss and poaching for domestic and international trade.
- Habitat: Endemic to peninsular India. Found in Eastern Ghats and southern Odisha and northern Andhra Pradesh.



Species in News

- **Leith's soft-shell turtle (*Nilssonia leithii*).**
- **Context-** has made to Appendix I from Appendix II of CITES
- Characteristics: Large fresh-water soft-shelled turtle.
- Can grow upto 1 m with average adult size varying from 700 mm to 1 m.
- Threats: High demand in traditional Chinese medicine and soup delicacy
- Habitat: Endemic to peninsular India and inhabits rivers and reservoirs.
- Found in all major rivers of the states of Maharashtra, Karnataka, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu and Orissa, like- Cauvery, Tungabhadra, Ghataprabha, Bhavani, Godavari and Moyar.



- Shisham
- It is found in abundance in India.
- However, it is included in CITES Appendix II because of the challenges in distinguishing different species of genus *Dalbergia* in their finished forms.
- As of now, every shisham consignment of weight above 10 kg requires a CITES permit.
- Due to this restriction, exports of furniture and handicrafts made of shisham from India have continuously fallen.
- On India's initiative at CoP19, it was agreed that any number of shisham timber-based items of weight less than 10kg could be exported as a single consignment without CITES permits.
- Further, it was agreed that for the net weight of each item, only shisham timber used would be considered.

About Shisham

- A deciduous tree ascending up to 25-30 m.
- Native to Indian subcontinent and southern Iran and occurs throughout sub-Himalayan tract from Ravi to Assam.
- Included in **Appendix II** of convention.
- Indian rosewood or the shisham tree is used to make durable dark-reddish tables, beds, bookshelves or chairs.
- State tree of Punjab.



- **Thelenota (Sea Cucumbers)**
- The EU proposed three species under genus Thelenota (sea cucumbers) to be included in Appendix II.
- CoP19 accepted the proposal. Sea cucumbers were one of the most frequently trafficked marine species from coastal India.
- **Ivory Trade : proposal to allow regular form of controlled ivory trade defeated**
- The ivory trade was banned globally in 1989 when all African elephant populations were put in CITES Appendix I.
- However, the African elephants of South Africa, Namibia, Botswana, and Zimbabwe were later transferred to Appendix II to allow one-time sales of ivory accumulated from deaths and poacher seizures.

- The endangered Asian elephant was included in CITES Appendix I in 1975, which banned the export of ivory from the Asian range countries.
- In CoP18, Zambia floated a proposal to downlist its elephants from Appendix I to Appendix II, which in effect, would have meant resuming the sale of its ivory stockpile. **CoP rejected the proposal.**
- India had abstained from voting against a similar proposal at CoP19.
- **CITES Tiger Enforcement Task Force**
- CoP19 has proposed a tentative budget of \$150,000 for the Big Cat Task Force. The objective of the task force is to curb illegal trade in big cats like lions, tigers, leopards, cheetahs, etc, in their range.

- Monitoring the illegal killing of elephants (MIKE)
- MIKE is an international collaboration that measures the trends and causes of elephant mortality. It was established by a CITES Resolution adopted in 1997. One of the core mandates is to build capacity in elephant range States.
- MIKE's information base is used to support international decision-making related to the conservation of elephants in Asia and Africa. The information and analyses are also presented at annual CITES meetings.

- TRAFFIC is an NGO (CITES, on the other hand, is a multilateral treaty) founded in 1976 as a joint programme of the World Wide Fund for Nature (WWF) and IUCN. Its headquarters is in Cambridge, UK.
- TRAFFIC is complementary to CITES. Its mission is to ensure that trade in wild plants and animals is not a
- threat to the conservation of nature. It investigates wildlife trade trends, patterns, impacts and drivers to provide the leading knowledge base on trade in wild animals and plants.

Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)



- **Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)**
- It is an international treaty, concluded under the aegis of the UN Environment Programme in 1979 in Bonn, Germany.
- It entered into force in 1983.
- CMS is also known as **Bonn Convention** or Global Wildlife conference.
- It is the **only global** and UN-based intergovernmental organization established **exclusively** for the conservation of terrestrial, aquatic, and avian migratory species throughout their range.
- Under CMS, migratory species threatened with extinction are listed on **Appendix I** (CMS global conservation list), and Parties strive towards strictly protecting these animals.

Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)



- Migratory species that would significantly benefit from international cooperation are listed in **Appendix II**.
- For this reason, the Convention encourages the Range States to conclude global or regional agreements.
- In this respect, CMS acts as a framework Convention.
- The agreements may range from legally binding treaties (called Agreements) to less formal instruments, such as Memoranda of Understanding, and can be adapted to the requirements of particular regions.
- The development of **models tailored** according to the conservation needs throughout the migratory range is a unique capacity to CMS.

Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)



- Example of Tailored Model :
- **Raptor MoU** : under aegis of UNEP and CMS : protection of birds of prey in africa and eurasia. India has many such birds, so india agreed to it in 2008. It is not legally binding.

Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)



APPENDICES OF CMS



Appendix I of the convention

- Migratory species threatened with extinction
- CMS Parties strive towards strictly protecting these animals, conserving or restoring the places where they live, mitigating obstacles to migration and controlling other factors that might endanger them. Besides establishing obligations for each State joining the Convention, CMS promotes concerted action among the Range States of many of these species.

Appendix II of the Convention

- Migratory species that need or would significantly benefit from international cooperation
- For this reason, the Convention encourages the Range States to conclude global or regional Agreements. In this respect, CMS acts as a framework Convention. The Agreements may range from legally binding treaties (called Agreements) to less formal instruments, such as Memoranda of Understanding, and can be adapted to the requirements of particular regions. The development of models tailored according to the conservation needs throughout the migratory range is a unique capacity to CMS.

Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)



- **13th Conference of the Parties to CMS (CoP13)**
- CoP13 was organized in 2020 in **Gandhinagar, Gujarat.**
- India has been designated the President of the COP for the next three years.
- **Uzbekistan** will host CoP14 on 23-28 October **2023.**
- Ten new species were added to CMS Appendices at COP13.
- Seven species were added to Appendix I, which provides the strictest protection.
- The Asian Elephant (EN), Great Indian Bustard (CR), Bengal Florican (CR), Little Bustard (NT) are among the 7 species.
- COP13 also adopted the **Gandhinagar Declaration.**
- It calls for ecological connectivity for migratory species to be integrated in the Post-2020 Global Biodiversity Framework.

Convention on Migratory Species (CMS)



Mascot of COP13- Great Indian
Bustard

Environment & Ecology by Dr. Shivin Chaudhary

[Click Here to Learn More](#)

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- UNCCD, along with the Convention on Biological Diversity (CBD) and the UNFCCC, emerged from the 1992 Rio de Janeiro Earth Summit.
- UNCCD was established in 1994 in Paris.
- It is ratified by 196 countries & European Union.
- India ratified the UNCCD Convention in 1996.
- UNCCD is an agreement for ensuring global action against land degradation.
- It is the only legally binding international agreement that links environment and development to sustainable land management.
- Desertification is NOT the creation of desert. We will understand this in pollution class.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- The Convention requires countries to draw up their **national action programmes (NAP)** using a **bottom-up approach** — from the local community up — to restore degraded lands.
- The Global Mechanism (GM) was established under UNCCD to assist countries in the mobilization of financial resources to implement the Convention.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- COP of the UNCCD
- The CoP is the supreme decision-making body of UNCCD.
- It is held every two years.
- The CoP reviews the implementation of the Convention, formulates strategies, coordinates its work with other agencies and NGOs, and so on.
- Recent COPs under UNCCD:
 - COP 13 – 2017 - Ordos City (China)
 - COP 14 – 2019 - New Delhi (India)
 - COP-15 – 2022 - Abidjan (Côte d'Ivoire)

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- Future meetings of the biennial Conference of the Parties to the UNCCD & its subsidiary bodies will be held in Saudi Arabia (COP16 in 2024) & Mongolia (COP17 in 2026).
- **COP 14, New Delhi (2019)**
- The Delhi Declaration was adopted to focus on better access and stewardship over land, with gender-sensitive transformative projects
- “Restore land, sustain future” was the theme of COP14.
- Only 25% of nations include gender discussions in land degradation targets
- The UNCCD mandates gender mainstreaming in advancing the efforts of countries to achieve their Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) targets.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- Report on Soil Organic Carbon
- Soil Organic Carbon (SOC) is pivotal in providing multifaceted benefits. It combats droughts, reduces soil diseases and soil compacting, and helps in organic production.
- Because of its multifunctional roles and its sensitivity to land management, SOC is one of the three global indicators of Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN).

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN)**
- A state whereby the amount and quality of land resources, necessary to support ecosystem functions and services and enhance food security, remains stable or increases within specified temporal and spatial scales and ecosystems.
- The concept of LND emerged from the UN Conference on Sustainable Development (Rio+20) in 2012.
- **Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) initiative**
- In 2015, LDN became a target for the SDG 15, which is about sustaining life on land.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- At COP12 to UNCCD, Parties adopted LDN as a “strong vehicle for driving implementation of UNCCD” and called on countries to set voluntary targets to achieve “no net loss” by 2030.
- **New Delhi Declaration:** 190+ countries agreed to achieve ‘land degradation neutrality’ by 2030 and vowed to ensure that the efforts in this direction do not affect land rights of forest dwellers and women.
- The countries will, however, must mobilise a huge sum of \$300 billion to step up the restoration exercise.
- **India’s LND Targets:** India will restore 26 million hectares of degraded land by 2030; earlier the target was 21 mha.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- The **Global Land Outlook (GLO)** is a UNCCD publication that underscores land system challenges, showcases transformative policies to cost-effective pathways to scale up sustainable land & water management
- **40 per cent of our planet's land is degraded**, which will directly affect half of humanity & is a threat to about 50 per cent of global GDP or around \$44 trillion.
- The world is slow on the restoration of one billion hectares of degraded land by 2030.
- **Findings of the report**
- **Loss of cropland due to urbanization**
- Human settlements have historically developed in the most fertile and accessible lands

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- Urbanisation is projected to cause the loss of between 1.6 and 3.3 million hectares of prime agricultural land per year in the period between 2000 and 2030
- Increasing **meat consumption** across the world has put great pressure on land.
- Reducing the average meat consumption from 100 grams to 90 grams per person per day would make a significant impact on both, human health and climate change
- **Water**
- The demand for water is projected to outgrow extraction capacity by 40 per cent by 2030.
- Around two-thirds of the world's population would be living in water-stressed countries by 2025.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- Demand of water for agricultural purposes will double by 2050 due to growing demands for food.
- The most water-intensive crops per kg of production are:
 1. cotton (7,000 to 29,000 litres/kg),
 2. rice (3,000 to 5,000 litres/kg),
 3. sugar cane (1,500-3,000 litres/kg),
 4. soya (2,000 litres/kg) and
 5. wheat (900 litres/kg).
- At present, two billion people and 40 per cent of irrigation were dependent on ground water. India (39 million hectares), China (19 mha) and the US (17 mha) were intensively using ground water.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Drought**
- There is a strong nexus between land use and drought and the management of both, land and drought, need to be fundamentally linked.
- Drought was one of the five 'Strategic Objectives' of the UNCCD for 2018-2030. UNCCD introduced the concept of 'drought-smart land management' (D-SLM) within the broader group of SLM (sustainable land management)-based interventions.
- **Cost**
- An investment of \$1.8 trillion in climate-adaptation measures over the next decade will bring about concrete transformation on the ground.
- [Mains 2020] The process of desertification does not have climatic boundaries. Justify with examples. (150 words).

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **COP 15, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire**
- COP15 theme: 'Land. Life. Legacy: From scarcity to prosperity'.
- Target is to restore one billion hectares of degraded land between now & 2030.
- The three key declarations of COP-15 included:
 1. **Abidjan Call** issued by the Heads of State & Government to boost long-term sustainability.
 2. **Abidjan Declaration** on achieving gender equality for successful land restoration.
 3. COP-15 "Land, Life & Legacy" Declaration, as a response to the findings of the UNCCD's flagship report, Global Land Outlook 2 (second edition of the GLO).

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **New commitments**
- Accelerate restoration of **one billion hectares of degraded land by 2030** by improving data gathering and monitoring.
- Establish an Intergovernmental Working Group on Drought for 2022-2024 to support a shift from reactive to proactive drought management.
- Address sand and dust storms and other escalating disaster risks by designing and implementing plans and policies.
- Ensure **greater synergies** among the **three Rio Conventions:** Convention on Biological Diversity, UNCCD, and UNFCCC.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Other Initiatives**
- **Drought in Numbers, 2022 report:** Identified that in 2022, more than 2.3 billion people face water stress.
- **Business for Land initiative:** for bringing visibility to the commitments made by participating companies towards land degradation neutrality, both in supply chains and CSR activities.
- **Sahel Sourcing Challenge:** To enable communities growing Great Green Wall (GGW) to use technology to monitor progress, create jobs and commercialize their produce.
- **GGW:** An African-led movement, to grow an 8,000 km belt of trees across the entire width of Africa.
- **Droughtland:** a new UNCCD public awareness campaign.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **The Sahel** is a semiarid region that forms a transitional zone between the Sahara to the north & tropical savannas to the south.
- It contains the fertile delta of the Niger.
- The Sahel's fertile land is rapidly becoming desert because of drought, deforestation, & intensive agriculture.
- **The Great Green Wall Initiative**
- It was launched in 2007 by the African Union. This ambitious project is being implemented across 22 African countries & will revitalize thousands of communities across the continent.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- The GGW initiative's ambition is to restore 100 mha of currently degraded land; sequester 250 million tons of carbon & create 10 million green jobs by 2030.
- Barely 18 per cent of the Great Green Wall's objectives for 2030 have been achieved.
- Lack of communication, funds, & coordination are among the greatest challenges faced by GGW.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)

The Great Green Wall Begins to Rise

Project: Reforestation of an 8,000 km corridor to combat desertification and the effects of climate change.
Benefits also include the creation of local jobs.

- Planned route
- Project member states



* based on 2019 data
Sources: UNCCD, Greatgreenwall.org



statista

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Initiatives launched under the UNCCD to combat land desertification and degradation**
- **Land Degradation Neutrality (LDN) Target Setting Programme:**
- UNCCD in collaboration with multiple international partners, are supporting interested countries with their national LDN target setting process.
- To date, over 120 countries, including India, have committed to setting LDN targets.
- **Land Degradation Neutrality Fund (LDN Fund):**
- Officially launched at UNCCD COP 13 in Ordos, China, it is the first-of-its-kind investment vehicle leveraging public money to raise private capital for sustainable land projects.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Land for Life Programme** was launched at the tenth UNCCD Conference of the Parties (COP10) in 2011 as part of the **Changwon Initiative**. The Programme seeks to address the challenges of land degradation desertification and mitigation of drought.
- Other initiatives:
- **Bonn Challenge:**
- Launched by the Government of Germany and IUCN in 2011, it is a global goal to bring 150 million hectares of degraded and deforested landscapes into restoration by 2020 and 350 million hectares by 2030. India has pledged to restore 21 million ha of degraded and deforested land by 2030.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Global Initiative on Reducing Land Degradation:**
- It aims to strengthen the implementation of existing frameworks to prevent, halt, and reverse land degradation within G20 member states and globally.
- **Reducing emissions from deforestation and forest degradation (REDD+):**
- It is a mechanism developed by Parties to the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC).
- It creates a financial value for the carbon stored in forests by offering incentives for developing countries to reduce emissions from forested lands and invest in low-carbon paths to sustainable development.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Steps taken by India to tackle the issue of land degradation**
- India is a party to UNCCD and has pledged to reach land degradation neutrality targets by 2030 as a part of the **Convention's Land Degradation Neutrality Strategy**.
- India promotes sustainable land management practices in agriculture sector through schemes such as **Pradhan Mantri Fasal Bima Yojana (PMFBY), Soil Health Card Scheme**, Soil Health Management Scheme, Pradhan Mantri Krishi Sinchayee Yojna (PKSY), Per Drop More Crop, etc. which are helping to reduce land degradation.

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- Ministry of Environment Forests and Climate Change (MoEFCC) consolidated the intervention on **participatory forest management** through the National Forest Policy, 1988, and then through enabling guidelines in 1990 on Joint Forest Management (JFM).
- JFM is a partnership involving both the forest departments and local communities in natural forest management.
- MoEFCC is implementing three major schemes for development of forest areas i.e., **National Afforestation Programme (NAP) scheme**, National Mission for a Green India (GIM) and Forest Fire Prevention & Management Scheme (FFPM).

United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD)



- **Bamboo Oasis on Lands in Drought (BOLD) Project**
- Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) launched Bamboo Oasis on Lands in Drought (BOLD) Project in **Rajasthan**.
- Project BOLD seeks to create bamboo-based green patches in arid and semi-arid land zones to reduce land degradation and prevent desertification.
- **Bamboo is a grass**, fast growing, and typically woody. It is distributed in tropical, subtropical and mild temperate zones.
- India is **second** only to China in terms of bamboo diversity.
- Benefits of bamboo cultivation: Conserves water and reduce evaporation of water from the land surface. Ideal for rehabilitating degraded soil with its unique ability to stitch and repair damaged soils.

2014

With reference to 'GEF', which of the following statements is/are correct?

- a) It serves as financial mechanism for 'Convention on Biological Diversity' and 'United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change'.
- b) It undertakes scientific research on environmental issues at global level
- c) It is an agency under OECD to facilitate the transfer of technology and funds to underdeveloped countries with specific aim to protect their environment.
- d) Both (a) and (b)

Answer: a)

- Explanation:
- GEF is an independent financial organisation (not a research body). It may fund scientific research but is not directly involved in it.
- IPCC takes care of most of the research work.

2016

With reference to ‘Agenda 21’, sometimes seen in the news, consider the following statements:

- 1) It is a global action plan for sustainable development.
- 2) It originated in the World Summit on Sustainable Development held in Johannesburg in 2002.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

PYQs: Q2



Answer: a) 1 only

Explanation:

- Agenda 21 came out as a part of Earth Summit 1992.

PYQs: Q3



Consider the below statements about Global Wildlife Programme (GWP):

1) GWP is a CITES led global partnership that promotes wildlife conservation and sustainable development

by combating illicit trafficking in wildlife.

2) The GWP is funded by the Global Environment Facility.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both
- d) None

PYQs: Q3



Answer: b) 2 only

It is a World Bank-led & GEF-funded partnership.

2015

What is Rio+20 Conference, often mentioned in the news?

- a) It is the UN Conference on Sustainable Development
- b) It is a Ministerial Meeting of the WTO
- c) It is a Conference of the IPCC
- d) It is a Conference of the Member Countries of the CBD

Answer: a)

Explanation:

Earth Summit 1992 (Rio de Janeiro)- UN Conference on Environment and Development

Earth Summit 2002 (Rio+10) (Johannesburg)- World Summit on Sustainable Development

Earth Summit 2012 (Rio+20) (Rio de Janeiro)- UN Conference on Sustainable Development

2018

The Partnership for Action on Green Economy (PAGE), a UN mechanism to assist countries in transition towards greener and more inclusive economies, emerged at (2018)

- a) The Earth Summit on Sustainable Development 2002, Johannesburg
- b) The United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development 2012, Rio de Janeiro
- c) The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change 2015, Paris
- d) The World Sustainable Development Summit 2016, New Delhi

Answer: b)

PYQs: Q5



Answer: b)

2015

With reference to the IUCN and the CITES, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1) IUCN is an organ of the United Nations and CITES is an international agreement between governments.
- 2) IUCN runs thousands of field projects around the world to better manage natural environments.
- 3) CITES is legally binding on the States that have joined it, but this convention does not take the place of national laws.

Select the correct using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

PYQs: Q6



Answer: b) 2 and 3 only

IUCN is an NGO. CITES is an international agreement between governments (multilateral treaty).

2011-12

Regarding "carbon credits", which one of the following statements is **not** correct?

- a) The carbon credit system was ratified in conjunction with the Kyoto Protocol.
- b) Carbon credits are awarded to countries or groups that have reduced GHGs below their emission quota.
- c) The goal of the carbon credit system is to limit the increase of carbon emission quota.
- d) Carbon credits are traded at a price fixed from time to time by the United Nations Environment Programme.

Answer: D

Explanation: Carbon credit prices are traded on an exchange. So, their prices are never fixed.

2015

Which one of the following is associated with the issue of control and phasing out of the use of ozone-depleting substances?

- a) Bretton Woods Conference
- b) Montreal Protocol
- c) Kyoto Protocol
- d) Nagoya Protocol

Answer: B

- Bretton Woods Conference established the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD) and the International Monetary Fund (IMF).
- **Montreal Protocol** is a legally-binding international treaty to protect the ozone layer by phasing out the production of ozone depleting substances.
- Kyoto Protocol implemented the objective of the UNFCCC to fight global warming by reducing GHG concentrations in the atmosphere to “a level that would prevent dangerous anthropogenic interference with the climate system”. It is binding on the parties.
- Nagoya Protocol is an agreement to the 1992 CBD on “Access to Genetic Resources and the Fair and Equitable Sharing of Benefits”.

Which of the following statements regarding ‘Green Climate Fund’ is/are correct?

- 1) It is intended to assist the developing countries in adaptation and mitigation practices to counter CC.
- 2) It is founded under the aegis of UNEP, OECD, Asian Development Bank and World Bank.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

PYQs: Q9



Answer: A

- **Explanation:** GCF is founded under the aegis of UNFCCC COP

2018

Momentum for Change: Climate Neutral Now” is an initiative launched by

- a) The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
- b) The UNEP Secretariat
- c) The UNFCCC Secretariat
- d) The World Meteorological Organisation

2018

Momentum for Change: Climate Neutral Now” is an initiative launched by

- a) The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change
- b) The UNEP Secretariat
- c) The UNFCCC Secretariat
- d) The World Meteorological Organisation

Answer: C

- Climate Neutral Now was launched by the UNFCCC secretariat in 2015. It is aiming at encouraging and supporting all levels of society to take climate action to achieve a climate-neutral world by mid-century, as enshrined in the Paris Agreement.

2016

Consider the following pairs:

Terms sometimes in the news -

1) Annex-I Countries -

2) Certified Emissions- Reductions

3) Clean Development Mechanism -

Their origin

Cartagena Protocol

Nagoya Protocol

Kyoto Protocol

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

a) 1 and 2 only

b) 2 and 3 only

c) 3 only

d) 1, 2 and 3

2016

Answer- C) 3 only

Explanation:

Annex-I Countries, Clean Development Mechanism, Certified Emission Reductions (CERs) or carbon credits are terms associated with the Kyoto Protocol.

2016

The term 'INDC' is sometimes seen in the news in the context of

- a) pledges made by the European countries to rehabilitate refugees from the war-affected Middle East
- b) plan of action outlined by the countries of the world to combat climate change
- c) capital contributed by the member countries in the establishment of Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank
- d) plan of action outlined by the countries of the world regarding Sustainable Development Goals

Answer: B

- Intended nationally determined contribution (INDC) is a non-binding national plan highlighting climate change mitigation, including climate-related targets for greenhouse gas emission reductions.

2016

With reference to the Agreement at the UNFCCC Meeting in Paris in 2015, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1) The Agreement was signed by all the member countries of the UN and it will go into effect in 2017.
- 2) The Agreement aims to limit the greenhouse gas emissions so that the rise in average global temperature by the end of this century does not exceed 2 °C or even 1.5 °C above pre-industrial levels.
- 3) Developed countries acknowledged their historical responsibility in global warming and committed to donate \$ 1000 billion a year from 2020 to help developing countries to cope with climate change.

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B

- The Agreement will **not become binding** on its member states until 55 parties who produce over 55% of the world's greenhouse gas have ratified the Agreement. There is doubt whether some countries, especially the United States, will agree to do so, though the United States publicly committed, in a joint Presidential Statement with China, to joining the Agreement in 2016.

- As of March 2019, 195 UNFCCC members have signed the agreement, and 185 have become a party to it.
- The **Paris Agreement's long-term goal** is to **keep the increase in global average temperature to well below 2 °C above pre-industrial levels;** and **to limit the increase to 1.5 °C**, since this would substantially reduce the risks and effects of climate change.

2014

Consider the following international agreements:

- 1) The International Treaty on Plant Genetic Resources for Food and Agriculture
- 2) The United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification
- 3) The World Heritage Convention

Which of the above has/have a bearing on the biodiversity?

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only,
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2. and 3

PYQs: Q15



2014

Answer- D) 1,2 and 3

2015

With reference to ‘Forest Carbon Partnership Facility’, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1) It is global partnership of governments, businesses, civil society and indigenous peoples.
- 2) It provides financial aid to universities, individual scientists and institutions involved in scientific forestry research to develop eco-friendly and climate adaptation technologies for sustainable forest management.
- 3) It assists the countries in their ‘REDD+ (Reducing Emission from Deforestation and Forest Degradation+)’ efforts by providing them with financial and technical assistance.

Select the correct answer using the code given below

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 and 3 only
- c) 1 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C

- **Explanation:** It provides financial incentives to countries in their REDD+ efforts. There is no mention of assistance to universities, scientists.

2015

‘BioCarbon Fund Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes’ is managed by the

- a) Asian Development Bank
- b) International Monetary Fund
- c) United Nations Environment Programme
- d) World Bank

Answer: D

- BioCarbon Fund Initiative for Sustainable Forest Landscapes (ISFL) is a multilateral fund, supported by donor governments and managed by the World Bank.

2016

What is ‘Greenhouse Gas Protocol’?

- a) It is an international accounting tool for government and business leaders to understand, quantify and manage greenhouse gas emissions
- b) It is an initiative of the United Nations to offer financial incentives to developing countries to reduce GHG emissions and to adopt eco-friendly technologies
- c) It is an inter-governmental agreement ratified by all the member countries of the UN to reduce GHG emissions to specified levels by the year 2022
- d) It is one of the multilateral REDD+ initiatives hosted by the World Bank

Answer: A

- Greenhouse Gas Protocol is an international accounting tool for government and business leaders to understand, quantify and manage greenhouse gas emissions

2017

Regarding 'Global CC Alliance', which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1) It is an initiative of the European Union.
- 2) It provides technical and financial support to targeted developing countries to integrate climate change into their development policies and budgets.
- 3) It is coordinated by World Resources Institute (WRI) and World Business Council for Sustainable Development (WBCSD).

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: A

- The Global Climate Change Alliance (GCCA) was launched in 2007 by the European Commission to strengthen dialogue and cooperation on climate change between the European Union (EU) and developing countries most vulnerable to climate change, in particular Least Developed Countries (LDCs) and Small Island Developing States (SIDS), which are hardest hit by the adverse effects of climate change.
- The GCCA acts as a platform for dialogue and exchange of experience between the EU and developing countries on climate policy and on practical approaches to integrate climate change into development policies and budgets.

PYQs: Q19



- The results of dialogue and exchange of views feed into the discussions on the post-2012 climate agreement under the UN Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC), and inform the technical and financial cooperation supported by the GCCA.
- Discussions take place at global, regional and national levels.
- The GCCA also provides technical and financial support to partner countries to integrate climate change into their development policies and budgets, and to implement projects that address climate change on the ground, promoting climate-resilient, low-emission development. Technical and financial cooperation, in turn, informs political dialogue and exchange of experience at regional and global levels.

2014

Consider the following countries:

- 1) Denmark
- 2) Japan
- 3) Russian Federation
- 4) United Kingdom
- 5) United States of America

Which of the above are the members of the ‘Arctic Council’?

- a) 1, 2 and 3
- b) 2, 3 and 4
- c) 1, 4 and 5
- d) 1, 3 and 5

PYQs: Q20

Answer: D



2016

Proper design and effective implementation of UN-REDD+ can significantly contribute to

- 1) Protection Of Biodiversity
- 2) Resilience Of Forest Ecosystems
- 3) Poverty Reduction

Select the correct answer using the code given below.

- a) 1 and 2 only
- b) 3 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: a) 1, 2 and 3 (UPSC Official Key)

Explanation:

- Poverty reduction is nowhere mentioned in the REDD+. But the question is not asking for specific details, “UN-REDD+ Programme can significantly contribute to?”
- Conservation, sustainable management of forests and enhancement of forest carbon stocks in developing countries will certainly contribute to employment opportunities and help in poverty reduction.
- According to FAO, REDD+ can also contribute to achieving other SDGs – including those which address poverty reduction, health and well-being, hunger alleviation, and improving institutions”

2018

With reference to the ‘Global Alliance for Climate Smart Agriculture (GACSA)’, which of the following statements is/are correct?

- 1) GACSA is an outcome of the Climate Summit held in Paris in 2015.
- 2) Membership of GACSA does not create any binding obligations.
- 3) India was instrumental in the creation of GACSA.

Select the correct answer using the code given

- a) 1 and 3 only
- b) 2 only
- c) 2 and 3 only
- d) 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B (2 only)

- The concept of Climate-Smart Agriculture (CSA) was originally developed by FAO and officially presented and at the Hague Conference on Agriculture, Food Security and Climate Change in 2010,
- GACSA is a voluntary platform open to governments, international and regional organizations, institutions, civil society, farmers' organizations and businesses who agree with its vision and its Framework Document.
- Being a member does not create any binding obligations and members determine their particular voluntary actions according to their needs and priorities.
- India is not a member of this organisation.

2017

Consider the following statements in respect of TRAFFIC:

1. TRAFFIC is a bureau under United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP).
2. The mission of TRAFFIC is to ensure that trade in wild plants and animals is not a threat to the conservation of nature.

Which of the above statements is/are correct?

- a) 1 only
- b) 2 only
- c) Both 1 and 2
- d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

- TRAFFIC, the wildlife trade monitoring network, is a **joint program of WWF and IUCN**, established by the WWF & IUCN to respond to the growing threat posed by illegal wildlife trade and overexploitation.
- Traffic aims to ensure that **trade in wild plants and animals** is not a threat to the conservation of nature.